

Stages of Scale

Founders to professional org

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PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Stages of Scale describe how an organisation transforms as it grows — from a small founder-led team to a professionally managed company — with distinct challenges at each stage.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Drawing on organisational-growth models such as Greiner's stages of growth.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to anticipate the organisational crises and transitions that accompany rapid growth.

FIGURE 1 · STAGES OF SCALE

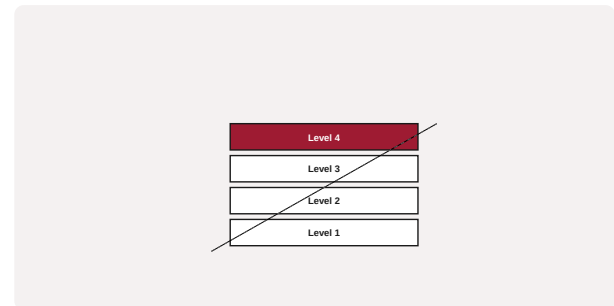


Figure 1. A schematic of the Stages of Scale as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The company's stage is identified; leadership and structure are evolved to meet the next stage's demands.

WHEN IT IS USED

When scaling an organisation and anticipating growing pains.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Founders, executives and HR leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It frames scaling as a series of organisational transformations, not merely getting bigger, preparing leaders for predictable crises.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Greiner, L.E. (1972) 'Evolution and revolution as organizations grow', Harvard Business Review, 50(4).
Wasserman, N. (2012) The Founder's Dilemmas. Princeton: PUP.